

PolicyGuardAI HR — Employee Code of Conduct

15-page generalized policy reference • HR policy retrieval, reasoning and escalation

Generalized from the supplied Employee Code of Conduct. Organization names, exact thresholds, dates and local approval titles are intentionally generalized.

Purpose

Create a professional, ethical, respectful and legally compliant workplace. The code guides employees, managers, contractors and other covered personnel in workplace conduct, business dealings and external interactions.

Scope

Apply to workplace activity, company systems, business travel, customer/vendor interactions, remote work, digital communications and situations where an individual represents the organization.

PolicyGuardAI interpretation

Treat each policy as a structured rule set: **scope** → **rule** → **required/prohibited action** → **exception** → **approval** → **evidence** → **escalation** → **consequence**.

Core principles

- Integrity, honesty, transparency and accountability.
- Respect, dignity, equal opportunity and inclusion.
- Protection of confidential information, intellectual property and company assets.
- Compliance with applicable laws and internal policies.
- Prompt reporting of suspected misconduct and protection against retaliation.

HR answer rule

Distinguish a clear policy requirement from a case needing HR/Legal review. Never invent a missing threshold, approval authority or legal deadline.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Values, Professional Conduct & Accountability

Values to operationalize

- Integrity: act honestly, keep personal and official interests separate, and correct mistakes.
- Respect: treat colleagues, customers, vendors and stakeholders professionally.
- Teamwork: share knowledge, credit, resources and constructive feedback.
- Ownership: take responsibility for actions, decisions, resources and outcomes.
- Continuous development: participate in relevant learning and improve capability.

Expected behaviour

- Use professional language and conduct in person and through digital channels.
- Avoid humiliating, threatening, abusive or degrading behaviour.
- Make work decisions on legitimate business criteria rather than personal bias.
- Follow policy even when pressured to bypass controls.

Manager accountability

Managers are also accountable for communicating expectations, listening to concerns, responding fairly, protecting confidentiality and taking reasonable steps to resolve issues.

PolicyGuardAI signal

Flag repeated disrespect, inconsistent treatment, unexplained exceptions or pressure to bypass controls.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Legal Compliance, Bribery & Anti-Corruption

Legal compliance

- Understand laws, regulations and internal rules relevant to the role and location.
- Seek guidance from the responsible manager, HR, Compliance or Legal function when unclear.
- Do not participate in activity that could violate applicable law.

Bribery and corruption

Bribery includes attempts to obtain improper advantage through payments, gifts, entertainment or other benefits. Kickbacks and unofficial facilitation payments are high-risk conduct.

Gifts, hospitality and donations

- Do not give or accept benefits intended to obtain business advantage or create an obligation.
- Apply additional caution with public officials or government-linked stakeholders.
- Nominal customary gifts may be acceptable only when consistent with the current policy.
- When uncertain, obtain approval before giving or accepting the benefit.

AI decisioning

Classify gifts/benefits by **purpose, recipient, value, timing, business context and approval status**, rather than value alone.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Financial Integrity, Fraud & Criminal Conduct

Financial records

- Record transactions accurately and completely.
- Look for undisclosed or unrecorded funds, assets or liabilities where the role requires it.
- Report and correct errors promptly.

Fraud and dishonesty

Deception, misrepresentation, fraudulent activity and dishonest conduct conflict with an integrity-based workplace. Suspected fraud should be reported through the designated reporting or whistleblower mechanism.

Red flags

- Manipulated records or missing supporting evidence.
- Unexplained payments, reimbursements or vendor benefits.
- Requests to backdate, conceal or misclassify transactions.
- Personal benefit linked to a business decision.

PolicyGuardAI handling

Separate **observation** from **allegation**. AI may identify a policy risk and recommend escalation, but should not declare an employee guilty.

Evidence

Transaction record, approval trail, correspondence, supporting document, involved parties, date/time and applicable policy version.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Conflict of Interest & Outside Activities

Conflict principle

A conflict may arise when personal, financial, family or outside interests could compromise—or appear to compromise—objective business decision-making.

Required actions

- Disclose actual, potential or perceived conflicts promptly.
- Prioritize legitimate organizational interests over personal gain.
- Avoid decisions where impartiality is compromised; recusal may be appropriate.
- Seek prior permission for outside business or activities where required.

Common scenarios

- Employee or close relative has an interest in a supplier, customer or competitor.
- Employee influences selection of a vendor with whom they have a personal relationship.
- Outside employment/consulting overlaps with organizational duties.
- Personal investment or benefit could influence a business decision.

AI decision logic

Ask: **Who benefits? What decision is affected? Is there a relationship/financial interest? Was it disclosed? Was approval obtained? Should the employee recuse?**

PolicyGuardAI HR • Confidentiality, Data Handling & Information Security

Confidential information

Protect non-public business information, records, customer/vendor information, research, processes, specifications, commercial information and other protected data.

Need-to-know

- Share confidential information only with authorized people who have a legitimate business need.
- Use appropriate confidentiality agreements for third-party sharing where required.
- Consult the responsible manager/security/legal function before transmitting sensitive information externally.

Security hygiene

- Keep passwords and security codes confidential.
- Report suspected breaches and reset compromised credentials promptly.
- Use approved/encrypted channels for sensitive information where required.
- Treat unexpected links, attachments and requests as suspicious.

Offboarding

On resignation/termination or request, company documents, electronic records and other company property should be returned. Confidentiality obligations can continue after employment ends.

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Use role-based access, minimum-necessary retrieval and audit logs. Do not expose restricted employee/company data in answers.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Intellectual Property & Company Assets

Intellectual property

Protect company logos, copyrights, patents, designs, processes, systems and other intellectual property. Use third-party IP only with appropriate authorization/agreement.

Employee responsibilities

- Follow brand and approved-use guidelines.
- Obtain written permission before third-party use where required.
- Report suspected misuse or infringement to Legal/IP.
- Do not copy, publish or repurpose protected material outside authorized use.

Company assets

Company devices, accounts, systems, documents, software, credentials and other resources should be used responsibly and for authorized work.

AI-specific risk

- Do not paste confidential company/customer data into an unapproved AI service.
- Do not use generated content that infringes rights or violates policy.
- Maintain provenance and review permissions for externally sourced material.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Human Rights, Equal Opportunity & Inclusion

Human-rights baseline

Respect freely chosen employment, a safe and healthy workplace, freedom of association, protection from forced labour/modern slavery and child labour, and dignified treatment.

Equal opportunity

Employment decisions should use legitimate job-related criteria such as qualifications, ability, performance and potential—not protected or irrelevant personal characteristics.

Where fairness applies

- Recruitment and selection.
- Assignment, promotion and career development.
- Compensation and benefits.
- Training and development.
- Discipline, redeployment and separation.

AI guardrail

Do not recommend employment decisions based on protected characteristics or proxies. Surface missing criteria and require human review for material employment decisions.

Fairness check

Ask whether the criterion is job-related, consistently applied, documented, reviewable and evidence-based.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Anti-Discrimination, Anti-Harassment & Dignity

Discrimination

Prohibited discrimination may be direct, indirect or retaliatory. Workplace decisions should not unfairly disadvantage people because of protected or irrelevant characteristics.

Harassment

Harassment can be verbal, visual, written or physical and may create an intimidating, hostile, humiliating or inappropriate work environment.

Examples to flag

- Repeated insults, threats, humiliation or unwanted criticism.
- Offensive or discriminatory messages, images or jokes.
- Unwelcome conduct that undermines dignity.
- Adverse treatment because someone raised a concern.

Reporting

Provide accessible channels through HR, management or designated grievance mechanisms. Handle reports confidentially to the extent appropriate and without retaliation.

AI behaviour

Acknowledge the concern, avoid blame, preserve confidentiality, recommend the designated reporting route and distinguish emergency/safety issues from ordinary guidance.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Sexual Harassment / POSH-Aware Handling

Core principle

The supplied code aligns its sexual-harassment section with India's workplace sexual-harassment framework and describes unwelcome sexual conduct, requests for sexual favours, sexually coloured remarks, pornography, stalking, physical contact and related hostile conduct.

Critical control

Route complaints to the organization's designated Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) / POSH mechanism where applicable. An AI system must not adjudicate the complaint.

Complaint handling

- Provide a clear, accessible complaint route.
- Protect complainants, witnesses and participants from retaliation.
- Maintain confidentiality and restrict case information to authorized personnel.
- Follow the applicable investigation and resolution process.

PolicyGuardAI must NOT

- Determine guilt or credibility solely from text.
- Pressure a complainant to confront the accused.
- Reveal identities or case details to unauthorized users.
- Invent statutory deadlines or outcomes.

Safe answer

"This may fall within the sexual-harassment policy. Please use the designated POSH/ICC reporting channel. I can explain the process, but I cannot adjudicate the complaint."

PolicyGuardAI HR • Safety, Intoxication, Workplace Security & Conduct

Safe workplace

Employees should participate in required safety training, understand emergency procedures and promptly report unsafe conditions or incidents.

Workplace security

Protect the workplace from violence, harassment, intimidation and unsafe/disruptive conditions, including relevant internal and external threats.

Intoxication

Policies may prohibit being under the influence of alcohol or other intoxicating substances while working or representing the organization. Use the applicable policy version for the exact rule.

Individual conduct

- Follow safety instructions and security controls.
- Do not create avoidable risk for colleagues, customers or visitors.
- Report accidents, threats and unsafe situations promptly.

Emergency escalation

If there is an immediate threat to life or safety, PolicyGuardAI should prioritize emergency/security escalation over routine HR guidance.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Communication, Media, Social Media & Competitors

Media

Unless authorized, employees should not speak for the organization. Media queries should be routed to the designated spokesperson/corporate communications function.

Social media

- Use professional conduct standards online as well as offline.
- Do not publish confidential internal documents, messages or discussions.
- Avoid abusive, harassing, defamatory, deceptive, obscene or hateful content.
- Make clear when views are personal where policy requires it.

Competitors

Exercise care in competitor interactions to avoid inadvertent disclosure of confidential or privileged information. Business-related competitor interactions may require approval.

PolicyGuardAI

Detect requests involving media statements, public disclosures, competitor information or confidential internal content and route authorization questions to the responsible owner.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Outside Employment, Association, Non-Solicitation & Workplace Rules

Double employment

The supplied conduct code prohibits simultaneous employment with another organization/business. Generalized implementation should treat concurrent employment and conflicting outside work as review items under the current employment agreement/policy.

Outside activity

Outside business, consulting, financial or professional activity may require prior approval when it conflicts with duties or organizational interests.

Freedom of association

Respect applicable employee rights to association and collective representation, subject to law and policy.

Non-solicitation

Where non-solicitation restrictions exist, retrieve exact scope, duration and exceptions rather than infer them.

Dress/professional presentation

Apply dress-code rules consistently, with reasonable accommodation and without discriminatory enforcement.

PolicyGuardAI HR • Fair Competition, Customers, Marketing & Quality

Fair competition

Conduct business honestly and without unfair practices or misuse of confidential competitor information.

Customers

Communicate product/service information honestly and accurately. Protect customer information and contractual obligations.

Fair marketing

Marketing claims should be supportable, accurate and consistent with approved information.

Quality

Do not knowingly conceal quality issues, defects, material limitations or relevant incidents. Escalate through the designated process.

AI review checklist

- Is the statement factual and supported?
- Could a reasonable customer be misled?
- Does it reveal confidential information?
- Does it create an unauthorized commitment?
- Does it misuse competitor information?

PolicyGuardAI HR • Reporting, Investigations, Non-Retaliation & Discipline

Duty to report

Report suspected bribery, fraud, harassment, discrimination, retaliation, safety issues, confidentiality breaches and other serious violations through designated channels.

Non-retaliation

People who report concerns, assist investigations or exercise rights should be protected from retaliation as required by policy and law.

Investigation principles

- Receive concerns objectively.
- Preserve relevant evidence.
- Limit access to authorized investigators.
- Give relevant parties an appropriate opportunity to respond.
- Document findings and actions.

Discipline

Consequences depend on severity, evidence, policy, employment terms and law and may range from corrective action to termination/legal referral.

AI boundary

AI can triage, summarize policy clauses, identify missing information and recommend escalation. It should not independently impose discipline or determine legal liability.

PolicyGuardAI HR • PolicyGuardAI Decision Framework & Source Boundary

Recommended response pipeline

Identify context → retrieve current policy → identify rule/exception → check authorization/evidence → assess risk → answer or escalate → log.

Priority routing

- Immediate safety/security → emergency escalation.
- Potential legal/statutory issue → HR/Legal/POSH/Compliance.
- Grievance/harassment → confidential HR/grievance route.
- Routine policy question → direct answer with source clause.
- Ambiguous/missing policy → state uncertainty and seek human review.

Structured policy object

Recommended fields: **policy_id**, **version**, **scope**, **topic**, **rule**, **prohibited_actions**, **required_actions**, **exceptions**, **approval_owner**, **evidence_required**, **escalation_owner**, **effective_date**, **review_date**.

Implementation checklist

- Versioned repository and effective dates.
- Role-based access and audit logs.
- Source-clause citations in answers.
- Human approval for high-impact employment decisions.
- Dedicated POSH, grievance, whistleblower and emergency workflows.

Source boundary

This is a generalized knowledge-base draft based on the supplied Employee Code of Conduct. Validate against the target employer's current policy and applicable law before production use.

Source basis: supplied Employee Code of Conduct (28 pages), including integrity, anti-corruption, conflicts, confidentiality, IPR, human rights, equal opportunity, harassment, safety, communications, competition, reporting and violations.